

Multi-Modal, Training-Free Crack Extraction via Generalized FRANGI Graph

EUVIP 2026 – Luxembourg

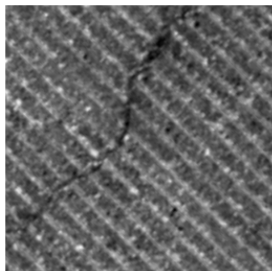
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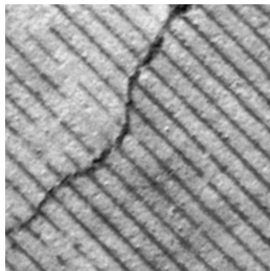
¹Inria, Université Côte d'Azur, Ayana research team, France

²Cerema, ENDSUM research team, France

Problem setting



Intensity [FIND 22]



Range / depth [FIND 22]

- ▶ Cracks are **thin**, **weak** and often **discontinuous**.
- ▶ Several modalities may observe the same geometry.
- ▶ Goal: extract an **editable crack skeleton without training**.
[EUVIP 26]

[FIND 22] S. Zhou, C. Canchila, W. Song. "Fused Image dataset for convolutional neural Network-based crack Detection (FIND)." Zenodo, 2022. [Dataset record](#).

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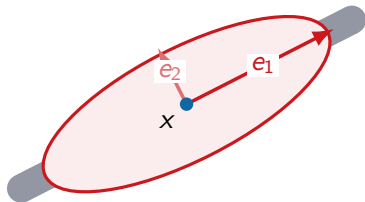
01

From pixels to a FRANGI graph



Classical FRANGI filter

$$\mathcal{H}_\sigma(x) = \nabla^2(G_\sigma * I)(x), \quad |\lambda_1| \leq |\lambda_2|.$$

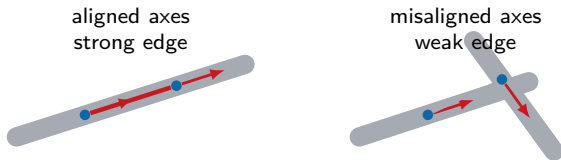


Local ridge geometry [Frangi 98]

- **Shape:** $R_B = |\lambda_1|/|\lambda_2|$
- **Contrast:** $S = \sqrt{\lambda_1^2 + \lambda_2^2}$
- **Direction:** e_1 follows the ridge
- **Polarity:** $F_\sigma = 0$ when $\lambda_2 \leq 0$

$$F_\sigma(x) = \exp\left(-\frac{R_B^2}{2\beta^2}\right) \left(1 - \exp\left(-\frac{S^2}{2c^2}\right)\right)$$

Generalized FRANGI graph



Pairwise orientation alignment [GRETSI 25] [EUVIP 26]

- ▶ Pixels become **nodes**.
- ▶ Ridge compatibility becomes **edge similarity**.
- ▶ Alignment refines intensity and shape information.

$$S_{ij}^{(0)} = \max_{\sigma \in \Sigma} S_{\text{int}}^{\sigma} S_{\text{shape}}^{\sigma} S_{\text{align}}^{\sigma}$$

[GRETSI 25] L. Hauseux, R. Antoine, P. Foucher, P. Charbonnier, J. Zerubia. "Généralisation du filtre de Frangi pour l'extraction des réseaux de fissures au sein d'images d'un glissement de terrain. Comparaison avec une méthode d'apprentissage profond." GRETSI, 2025.

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Multimodal fusion

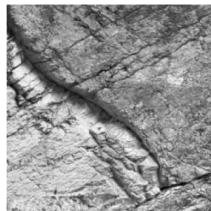
1. Normalize each Hessian

$$\hat{\mathcal{H}}_{\sigma}^{(m)}(x) = \frac{\mathcal{H}_{\sigma}^{(m)}(x)}{\max_{y \in \Omega} \|\mathcal{H}_{\sigma}^{(m)}(y)\|_2}$$

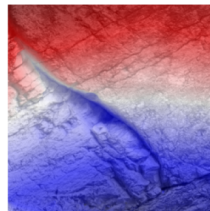
2. Fuse operators before eigendecomposition, with $w_m \geq 0$ and $\sum_m w_m = 1$

$$\mathcal{H}_{\sigma}^{\text{fused}}(x) = \sum_m w_m \hat{\mathcal{H}}_{\sigma}^{(m)}(x)$$

Palais des Papes [EUVIP 26]



Intensity
© Cerema

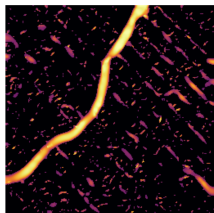


Depth overlay
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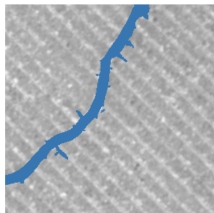
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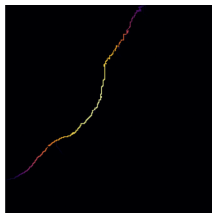
Extraction pipeline



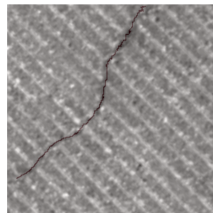
Similarity



Component



Centrality



Skeleton [EUVIP 26]



$$d_{ij} = \min\{1, \rho_{ij}(1 - S_{ij}^{(0)})\}, \quad S_{ij} = 1 - d_{ij}, \quad 0 < \rho_{ij} = \|x_i - x_j\|_2 \leq R$$

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02

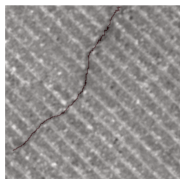
Experimental results



FIND: clean data



Ground truth
[FIND 22]



Our result
[EUVIP 26]

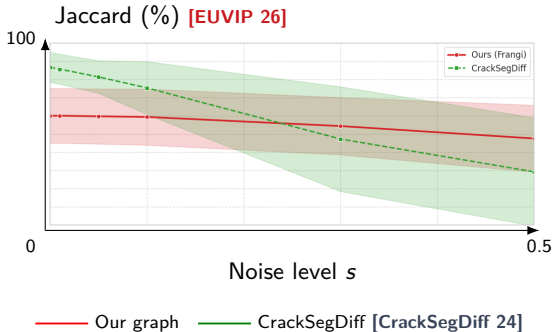
Method	IoU $\uparrow$	Tversky $\uparrow$	Wasserstein $\downarrow$
Our graph [EUVIP 26]	63%	71%	11 px
CrackSegDiff [CrackSegDiff 24]	87%	90%	5 px

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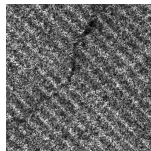
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[CrackSegDiff 24] X. Jiang, L. Jiang, A. Wang, K. Zhu, Y. Gao. "CrackSegDiff: Diffusion Probability Model-based Multi-modal Crack Segmentation." [arXiv:2410.08100](#), 2024.

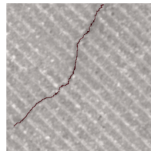
FIND: synthetic noise



$$I_s = I(1 + N), \quad R_s = R + N'$$
$$N, N' \sim \mathcal{N}(0, s^2) \text{ independent}$$



Noisy intensity



Our result,
 $s = 0.5$

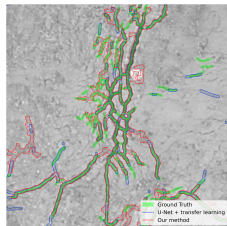
► Slower degradation under added noise.

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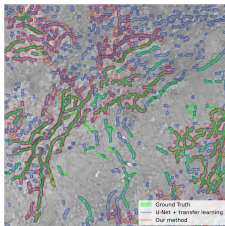
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Transfer to geological images

Vaches Noires [EUVIP 26]



Test 1
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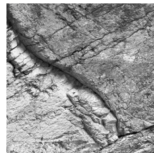


Test 2
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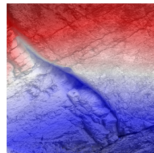
Ours Ground truth U-Net

- IoU 47 / 50% and 29 / 34% (ours / adapted U-Net)

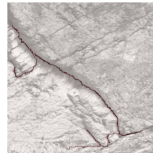
Palais des Papes [EUVIP 26]



Intensity
© Cerema



Depth overlay
© Cerema



Our result
© Cerema

- Main fracture recovered
- No retraining

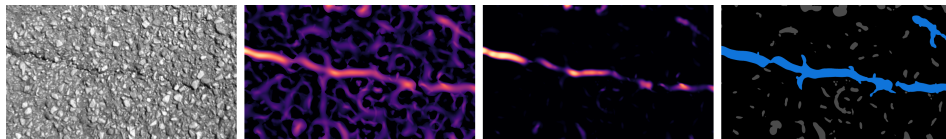
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03

Beyond pairwise connectivity



Toward order $K = 2$



granular image

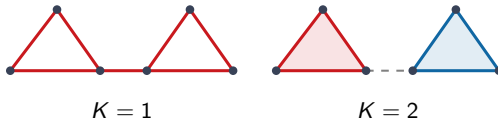
pixel-wise FRANGI

graph similarity

retained component

VT-GraF © Cerema

- ▶ Granular background can create spurious chains.
- ▶ $K = 1$: connectivity through vertices.
- ▶ $K = 2$: connectivity through triangles. [ANS 26]



[ANS 26] L. Hauseux, K. Avrachenkov, J. Zerubia. "Generalization of Single-Linkage with higher-order interactions." Applied Network Science, 11, article 9, 2026.

Conclusion & perspective

Main steps

- ▶ FRANGI filter → FRANGI graph
[EUVIP 26]
- ▶ Multimodal fusion at the Hessian level
- ▶ Training-free extraction of crack skeletons

Next steps

- ▶ Evaluate higher-order connectivity
- ▶ Broader benchmarks
- ▶ Can a FRANGI graph hierarchy help guide SAM / CrackSAM?
[SAM 23] [CrackSAM 24]



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[SAM 23] A. Kirillov et al. "Segment Anything." ICCV, pp. 4015–4026, 2023. [Paper](#).

[CrackSAM 24] K. Ge, C. Wang, Y. Guo, Y. Tang, Z. Hu, H. Chen. "Fine-tuning vision foundation model for crack segmentation in civil infrastructures." Construction and Building Materials, 431, 136573, 2024. [DOI](#).

Bibliography: method and experiments

[Frangi 98]

A. F. Frangi, W. J. Niessen, K. L. Vincken, M. A. Viergever.
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[GRETSI 25]

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Bibliography: higher order and perspectives

[ANS 26]

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